Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Machine Learning Engineer – Customer Support AI role at Quillstone Payments. I am a data scientist at Thistlebox, where I have developed forecasting and churn models and built tools for experimentation. I am interested in bringing that applied modelling experience to customer operations while growing further in production machine learning engineering.

My recent work includes a six-week recipe-demand forecasting workflow using LightGBM, scheduled through Vertex AI Workbench and writing results to BigQuery. It improved WAPE from 23% to 14%, with an estimated 9% reduction in food waste. I also developed a weekly-scored XGBoost churn model for retention targeting; in a 10% holdout validation, churn was down 2.1 percentage points in the treated group. These projects have given me practical experience with feature engineering, model evaluation and scheduled data workflows using Python and GCP tools.

I have also built a Streamlit app for sequential experiment planning and analysis, used by approximately 25 colleagues in product and growth. I wrote its Dockerfile, while the data platform team handled Cloud Run hosting and deployment. In 2025, I began adding pytest unit tests to forecasting feature code, reaching approximately 60% coverage. I would be glad to bring this pragmatic, collaborative approach to Quillstone's AI team as it works with product and engineering colleagues to help merchants and support agents.

Thank you for considering my application. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my modelling and workflow experience could contribute to the team.

Kind regards,
Tobias Mwangi-Hartley